

DAVID O'NEAL

GRC Engineering | AI Security & Governance | Security Operations

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SUMMARY

Cybersecurity professional with 8+ years across security operations, vulnerability management, and security program delivery in financial services, government, aerospace, and industrial environments. Proven track record reducing security risk, accelerating remediation timelines, and building repeatable security processes through automation.

At Bank OZK, investigated phishing, malware, BEC, and DLP incidents daily while tuning detection rules across Proofpoint, Microsoft Defender, and Cisco SEG, cutting phishing false positives by 40% and giving the team cleaner signal on real threats.

At Legato Security, led vulnerability and patch management for enterprise clients, cutting critical remediation timelines from several weeks to under 72 hours and managed project delivery across 10+ enterprise accounts as Project Manager at an MSSP.

Outside of work, building toward GRC Engineering and AI security through the GRC Engineering Portfolio in Python and Terraform at gitlab.com/doneal78-group and OracleRecon Shield, an AI-powered SMB risk assessment platform on the Gemini API. Targeting GRC Engineering and AI security roles. M.S. in Cybersecurity from Maryville University.

Certifications: GRC Foundations in Cybersecurity (2024); PSAA, In Progress; Introduction to Hacking Methodology (2026); Level 1 Cyber Threat Hunting Training (2024); SOAR Analyst, Google Cloud Siemplify (2024); XM Cyber Exposure Management (2024); VMDR, Qualys (2024); Insider Threat Detection, Teramind (2024); Chronicle SIEM Fundamentals (2024)

Security Frameworks: NIST 800-53, NIST AI RMF, ISO 27001, SOC 2

AI Technical: Python automation, Google Gemini API integration, prompt engineering, local LLM tools (Ollama)

AI GRC: AI-assisted risk assessment, LLM-assisted policy drafting, AI governance advisory for SMBs

CORE COMPETENCIES

GRC & Compliance: NIST 800-53, NIST AI RMF, ISO 27001, SOC 2, Control Mapping, Audit Support, SOP Development

AI Security & Governance: AI Risk Assessment, Gemini API Integration, Prompt Engineering, LLM-assisted Policy Generation

Security Automation: Python, Flask, CLI Tools, API Integration, JSON/CSV Pipelines, Git, GitLab, Terraform

Security Operations: SOC Analysis, Detection Tuning, Incident Response, Log Analysis, Threat Hunting

Vulnerability Management: Tenable.io, Nessus, PDQ Deploy, CVE Prioritization, Patch Automation, SLA Compliance

SIEM & Tooling: Splunk, Sentinel, Chronicle, Defender, CrowdStrike, Proofpoint, Jira

EXPERIENCE

Project Manager

Sep 2025 - Jul 2026

Legato Security | Remote

- Directed security service delivery for 10+ enterprise clients at an MSSP, coordinating across SOC analysts, engineers, and channel partners to keep projects on track and services delivered on time.
- Developed standardized onboarding workflows and milestone tracking in GuideCX, improving project visibility and reducing time to onboard new clients.
- Wrote QBRs and delivery updates that translate technical security work into plain language for client leadership.

Cybersecurity Consultant

Apr 2025 - Jul 2025

Legato Security | Remote

- Managed vulnerability and patch remediation for 279+ endpoints across regulated aerospace and industrial environments, prioritizing by risk level and business impact.
- Redesigned remediation workflows and automated patch deployment, cutting critical vulnerability remediation from several weeks to under 72 hours. More than 80% faster.
- Built a Patching-as-a-Service delivery framework that standardized remediation and developed audit-ready SOPs, risk classifications, and remediation documentation for regulated clients.

State IT Security Specialist

Oct 2024 - Mar 2025

Arkansas Department of Public Safety | Little Rock, AR

- Maintained patch compliance above 95% across 500+ endpoints through automated deployment and consistent remediation tracking, improving audit readiness.
- Handled IAM for the department, covering provisioning, deprovisioning, MFA resets, and access reviews in Active Directory and Azure AD.
- Mapped controls to NIST 800-53, collected audit evidence, and prepared compliance documentation that directly supported state regulatory audit responses.

SOC Analyst

Oct 2021 - Jun 2024

Bank OZK | Little Rock, AR

- Investigated and resolved 30+ phishing, malware, BEC, and DLP incidents per week in a financial-sector SOC, completing phishing investigations in under 20 minutes while maintaining response SLAs and documenting findings for audit.
- Reduced phishing false-positive alerts by 40% through detection rule tuning across Proofpoint, Microsoft Defender, and Cisco Secure Email Gateway, giving the team cleaner signal and less time chasing noise.
- Developed DLP incident response procedures that standardized investigations, reduced analyst decision-making time, and improved audit traceability.

System Operations Analyst I

Jun 2017 - Oct 2021

FIS Global | Little Rock, AR

- Monitored enterprise systems around the clock using Splunk, responded to service disruptions in real time, and supported root cause investigations.
- Maintained operational playbooks and documentation to support audit compliance and SLA consistency.

TECHNICAL PROJECTS

OracleRecon Shield | oracle-recon-insight.lovable.app

Jun 2026

AI-powered SMB risk assessment platform built on Google Gemini 2.5 Flash. Business owners answer 25 questions across 6 security domains and receive an AI-generated report with a risk grade, prioritized vulnerabilities, and a remediation roadmap, cutting assessment time from several days to under 30 minutes. Concept to live in under 8 hours, built solo.

Compliance Automation Lab | gitlab.com/doneal78-group

Jun 2026 - Present

A live GRC engineering build following AJ Yawn's GRC Engineering for AWS curriculum, documented at gitlab.com/doneal78-group. Started by automating the manual work: four Python tools covering control mapping across NIST 800-53, ISO 27001, and SOC 2; automatic risk scoring in a Flask web app; a compliance evidence collector that pulls audit artifacts from APIs rather than chasing control owners; and an AI policy generator running through Ollama. From there, moved into infrastructure: a boto3 AWS Config compliance checker, then a Terraform baseline that moved a live account from 40% AT RISK to 78% NEEDS IMPROVEMENT. Security Hub followed with FSBP and CIS v1.2.0. The GRC Engineering Club weekly challenges extended the build: a GitHub Actions CI/CD gate that blocks non-compliant configs before merge, Cosign keyless signing with tamper verification on infrastructure artifacts, and a NIST 800-53 Rev 5 baseline deployed into a live Security Hub account alongside existing standards. Built in public on LinkedIn.

Cybersecurity Home Lab | TCM Security PSAA Capstone

Jan 2025 - Present

VirtualBox lab with Windows and Ubuntu workstations standing in for a small enterprise network. Working through the TCM Security PSAA curriculum for hands-on IR, log analysis, and detection engineering outside of work.

EDUCATION

MARYVILLE UNIVERSITY OF SAINT LOUIS, ONLINE/REMOTE

M.S., Cybersecurity, 2021 | Cum Laude

UNIVERSITY OF ARKANSAS GRANTHAM, ONLINE/REMOTE

B.S., Information Technology, 2019

UNIVERSITY OF ARKANSAS PULASKI TECHNICAL COLLEGE

A.S., Computer Information Systems, 2017